

Question 34 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how HRD practices can be aligned with organisational strategy in a rapidly changing organisation.

Introduction

A rapidly changing organisation faces new technology, markets, structures or competition every year, sometimes every quarter. Strategy itself is revised often. Alignment cannot mean a five-year frozen training list. Analysis should show how HRD practices — TNA, appraisal, career, training methods, OD — can stay coupled to a moving strategy. The need is agility with direction, not chaos and not rigidity.

Detailed points

- 1. Continuous translation of strategy into competencies.** Whenever strategy shifts (new product, digital channel, new geography), HRD and business heads quickly update ‘what people must be able to do’. Waiting for the next printed handbook is misalignment. This translation meeting is the core alignment practice.
- 2. Shorter diagnosis cycles.** Pulse TNA, short climate checks, and looking at error data quarterly rather than a giant study every three years. Fast change creates new gaps quickly; slow diagnosis trains yesterday’s need.
- 3. Flexible learning methods.** Blended, just-in-time, on-the-job, e-learning and short workshops beat only long residential courses. People cannot leave a crisis workplace for two weeks every time the software changes. Method flexibility is how alignment stays practical.
- 4. Organisation development, not only skill training.** Rapid change is also emotional and structural: new teams, mergers, lost roles. HRD must facilitate change, counselling and new collaboration. Alignment includes helping people through the change that strategy created.
- 5. Career systems that allow movement.** Rigid ladders assume a stable pyramid. In rapid change, projects, lateral moves and temporary leadership roles develop people faster. Career planning remains, but paths are reviewed more often (notes already say career planning is continuous because environment changes).
- 6. Line managers and HRD in the same business review.** Alignment is a conversation rhythm: ‘here is the market shift; here is the capability risk; here is the development action this quarter.’ If HRD is not in the room, practices drift.
- 7. Stopping obsolete practices.** Alignment is also subtraction. Drop appraisal items and courses that belong to yesterday’s strategy so that people are not pulled in two directions. Analysis: adding without deleting is false alignment.
- 8. New measures of HRD success.** In a fast context, judge HRD by speed of capability building and change readiness, not only by number of programmes. What you measure is what aligns. Evaluation must match the strategy’s time pressure.

Conclusion. In a rapidly changing organisation, alignment is a repeating loop: translate strategy → diagnose quickly → learn flexibly → support change → review career and drop obsolete practices. Write methods, not slogans. Frozen HRD cannot serve a moving strategy.